Chelsea 2026 Site Induction

Please read this Site Induction carefully. It provides useful safety information for working on the show site and within the grounds of The Royal Hospital Chelsea, access arrangements, what to do in the event of an emergency and welfare facilities.

Access to Site

RHS Chelsea Flower Show, Bull Ring Gate, London, SW3 4LW.
What Three Words
Google Maps

The shows team, including operations and health & safety, can be found in the **Organisers Compound** which is located near **Bull Ring Gate** for all your queries.

Accreditation is only available at Bull Ring Gate, if you need to request or collect access passes you must enter site at this gate.

All access passes must be scanned on entry to site and carried on your person at all times.

Vehicle Access

All vehicles entering site must be registered on the Vehicle Booking System to gain entry to site, full details of these arrangements can be found on the onlinezone by your account administrator.

Site Access Arrangements

Parking

All vehicles must be removed from the show site once unloaded, offending vehicles may be removed without warning. Only "essential working vehicles" can remain on site with an appropriate vehicle pass.

Parking options are available in Burtons Court and Battersea Park, full details of these arrangements can be found on the online zone by your account administrator.

Site Access Arrangements

Cycling/Scooters

Bicycles and scooters use, including electric powered, within the show site is NOT permitted at any time. Bike racks are available in Burtons Court.

Basic Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) Requirements

High Visibility Vests (must be flourescent) and safety footwear must be worn at all times during build up and breakdown.

Other PPE may be required such as safety helmet, eye and hearing protection, and gloves in accordance with your own risk assessments or work activity.

Site Opening Hours

Time Period	Date	Site Open Times
Build-up	Thursday 23 April	7am - 7pm
	Friday 24 April	7am - 7pm
	Satuday 25 April	7am - 7pm
	Sunday 26 April	7am - 7pm
	Monday 27 April	7am - 7pm
	Tuesday 28 April	7am - 8pm
	Wednesday 29 April	7am - 8pm
	Thursday 30 April	7am - 8pm
	Friday 1 May	7am - 8pm
	Saturday 2 May	7am* - 8pm (*Ranelagh Gardens 8am)
	Sunday 3 May	8am* - 8pm (*Ranelagh Gardens 9am)
	Monday 4 My	7am - 8pm
	Tuesday 5 May	7am - 8pm
	Wednesday 6 May	7am - 8pm
	Thursday 7 May	7am - 8pm
	Friday 8 May	7am - 8pm
	Saturday 9 May	7am* - 8pm (*Ranelagh Gardens 8am)
	Sunday 10 May	8am* - 8pm (*Ranelagh Gardens 9am)
	Monday 11 May	7am - 8.30pm
	Tuesday 12 May	7am - 8.30pm
	Wednesday 13 May	7am - 8.30pm
	Thursday 14 May	7am - 8.30pm
	Friday 15 May	7am - 8.30pm
	Saturday 16 May	7am - 8.30pm
	Sunday 17 May	7am - 9pm
Preview Day	Monday 18 May	6.30am - 11pm
Show Open Days	Tuesday 19 – Thursday 21 May	6.30am - 10pm
	Friday 22 – Saturday 23 May	6.30am - 10.30pm
Breakdown	Sunday 24 May - Thursday 28 May	7am - 8pm
	Friday 29 May onwards	7am - 8pm

Key Site Contact Numbers

Contact	Number
General Site Queries	02034752708
First Aid	02034752739
Security & Emergency Line	02034752736

Welfare Arrangements

Water: Drinking water points are located across site, only use points labelled 'Drinking Water'.

Toilet & Hand Wash: Use the toilets and hand wash facilities provided across site, do not pollute the area.

Rest: You can rest in the Crew (Exhibitor) Restaurant where there is undercover seating and free tea & coffee.

Catering Restaurant: Served from Saturday 2 May - Tuesday 26 May

Wi-Fi: Free Wi-Fi hotspots across the site, these are designed for basic work-related functions only.

Security: There is 24 hour security onsite however the RHS does not accept any responsibility for any goods or materials lost or stolen.

Accessibility: If you have any accessibility questions or concerns, please speak to the Operations Team at **Chelsea FOH**.

We recommend you familiarise yourself with welfare locations before commencing any work. If you need help locating visit the organisors compound near Bull Ring Gate.

Chelsea Build & Break Welfare Arrangements & Site Plan

First Aid

Identify who are your nominated first aiders - you should have one on site as part of your team? And where is your first aid kit?

If you need help there is first aid cover on site during the site opening times located at the Happa Hut on Western Avenue, 020 3475 2739.

If there is an emergency call 999 and inform the RHS team.

Accidents, Incidents & Near Misses

Accidents / incidents of any nature must be reported to the Health and Safety Advisor or Operations Team immediately - even minor ones, it could prevent a more serious one.

If you are unsure or are concerned about something don't hesitate to advise us.

Details of all near-misses or accidents resulting in injury (RIDDOR or not) must be reported and investigated, you are required to co-operate with any investigation.

General Vehicle Movements

- Drive slowly, the **site speed limit is 5mph**
- Stick to designated routes and avoid driving on the grass.
- Do not park under tree canopies or blocking access routes.
- You must not be under the influence of alcohol or drugs.
- Be vigilant of the busy confined site, other vehicles and those working around you.
- Be alert for pedestrians.
- Reversing vehicles must use a banksman.

Plant Machinery Movements

- Plant must only be operated by trained operatives for its intended purpose, and operator carries relevant in date license/ticket on their person.
- Passengers must only travel in vehicles designed to transport passengers.
- No mobile phone use or listening to music whilst in operation.
- Remember, the **speed limit is 5mph.**
- Use seat belts, if fitted.
- No passengers carried unless a proper seat is fitted for each one of them.
- Reversing plant must use a banksman.

Pedestrians be vigilant, anticipate plant moving and rotating in unusual directions.

Site Conditions

Check the weather forecast and ensure you arrive prepared:

- Clothing suitable for the weather - waterproofs, layers, light weight, warm hats
- Sun cream, sun hats
- Stay hydrated, bring a refillable bottle
- In this outdoor environment you may be more susceptible to hay fever / allergens / biting insects or similar, carry a supply of any personal medications.

Be mindful how your surroundings change in adverse weather conditions, such as how surfaces can become slippery when wet, trip hazards hidden when muddy.

Please report any areas of the site that appear to be hazardous such as water pooling, quagmire etc. to the Operations Team.

Protecting the Site

Stick to designated traffic routes.
Adhere to Tree Protection Zones.
Pick up all your rubbish.
Report any spillages immediately.
Do not harm the existing park infrastructure or attach anything to it.
Avoid storing materials that may damage trees, shrubs or flowers.

Permits/Permissions to Work

These are obtained on site from the Health & Safety Advisor:

- Work in confined spaces
- Work in excavations (greater than 800mm)
- Hot works (including disc cutting or grinding, welding, gas cutting etc.)
- Work at height (excluding normal use of ladders for access purposes or of a short duration)
- Water features
- Naked flames/fire (heaters, fire pits, pizza ovens etc.)
- COSHH related works
- Load bearing structures
- Craning or lifting
- Generator use
- Working on or near bodies of water
- Early or late working

Working at Height

Only if absolutely necessary AND in accordance with your risk assessment. Any working at height other than normal ladder use requires a **Work Permit** from the Health & Safety Adviser.

Where using ladders or step ladders :

- Should be used for short durations.
- Must be regularly maintained and checked for visual defects prior to each use.
- Used by an adequately trained person.
- Placed on firm, even ground and footed.
- Be of sufficient size/height to comfortably reach the working area without having to stand on the top 3 rungs or over reach.

Fire

Ensure you know the locations of emergency exits, fire extinguishers and how to raise the alarm.

If you detect a fire, leave the area by the safest route possible and assemble in a place of safety and raise the alarm: Shout Fire and inform the Operations Team immediately.

Do not attempt to tackle a fire unless you are competent and capable to do so - never put yourself in danger.

Unattended Items

Use the **HOT** (**H**idden, **O**bvious, **T**ypical) protocol to inform your judgement.
If after applying the **HOT** protocols you still believe the item to be suspicious, call 999 and inform the **Security** team.

Suspicious Actions

What to do if someone's behaviour appears suspicious, if it is not what you would normally expect - then you must act without delay.
If you come across suspicious activity, you must not ignore it. What you do will depend on many factors, but you must**TELL** someone.
If safe to do so, you can approach a person that has been seen acting in a suspicious manner and ask them to account for their actions - Begin with a friendly 'Can I help you'? Be confident, be polite but challenge them if you can – use your communication skills.
If you are not satisfied by their answers and suspect immediate danger, move away and call 999 giving the following detail:
WHO did you see, what did they look like, what were they wearing?
WHAT have you seen, what has happened?
WHERE did the situation happen and where were you?
WHEN did it happen – what time?
WHY did you think it was suspicious?

Report any suspicious behaviour

In the RARE event of Fire Arms or Weapon attacks, Stay Safe and remember these words:

Conduct

We expect anyone associated with the show to conduct themselves in a responsible and professional manner.

Be aware abusive or threatening behaviour may result in the individuals concerned being evicted from site and accreditation withdrawn.

Disciplinary Action in Relation to Safety Breaches

Health & Safety is the responsibility of everyone, we all have a duty to ensure the safety of ourselves, co-workers, other exhibitors, contractors and the public who may be affected by our actions or omissions working on the Chelsea site.

Any one of us could be prosecuted, fined, even imprisoned for not working safely. Everyone has the right to expect to return home from work safely and without injury.

Breaking safety rules will result in a warning to the person concerned and to the company/organisation employing them on the site.

Repeat breaking of safety rules will result in the person being removed from site and accreditation withdrawn.

Declaration

When submitting I acknowledge and will comply with the following whilst on site:

I will co-operate with the organisers and other site users at all times.

I will work safely, have consideration for others who may be affected by my actions.

I will report any accident, incident, near miss or unsafe working practises/conditions or broken/malfunctioning equipment.

I will not use any equipment on which I have not been trained or intentionally misuse any provided equipment, machinery or facilities.

I will keep my workplace tidy and free from hazards.

I will adhere to all site safety notices and site regulations

I will follow instructions from the RHS and all their representatives including Safety, Security, Traffic, Venue Management Team and H&S Teams.

Always work in a safe and responsible manner. Develop a positive and pro-active approach towards health & safety.